

# Asian Englishes World Englishes

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# What Are World Englishes?

## Definition:

- The global varieties of English spoken in diverse cultural, social, and linguistic contexts.
- Includes **Inner Circle**, **Outer Circle**, and **Expanding Circle** Englishes (Kachru, 1985).

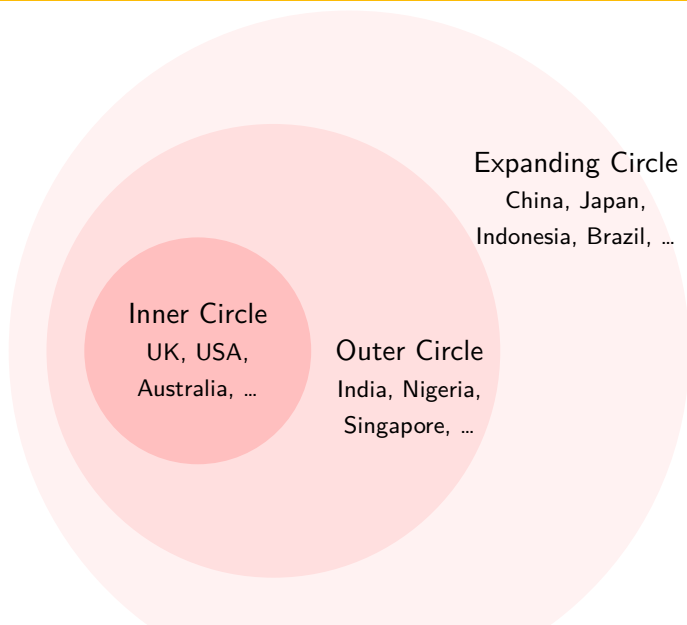
## Importance:

- Reflects the spread of English as a global lingua franca.
- Highlights the adaptability and localization of English in different regions, especially in Asia.

## Examples:

- British English, Indian English, Chinese English, Nigerian English.

# Kachru's Three Circles of English



# The Inner Circle

## Definition:

- Represents countries where English is the native language and primary means of communication.

## Examples:

- United Kingdom, United States, Australia, Canada, New Zealand.

## Key Features:

- England and former settler colonies where English became dominant (USA, Canada, Australia, New Zealand).
- Sets linguistic norms often viewed as "standard" English.
- Used as a cultural identifier.

# The Outer Circle

## Definition:

- Countries where English serves as a second language, often used in government, education, and business.
- Reflects historical colonial influence.

## Examples:

- India, Nigeria, Singapore, Philippines.
- Singapore fits almost all characteristics of inner circle except origin, ...

## Key Features:

- Nativized varieties of English.
- High degree of multilingualism among speakers.
- Functional roles in administration and education.
- More speakers than the inner circle

# The Expanding Circle

## Definition:

- Countries where English is used as a foreign language.
- Primarily for international communication and business.

## Examples:

- China, Japan, Brazil, Russia.

## Key Features:

- Does not have a colonial legacy of English.
- Lacks institutionalized functions in government or education.
- Growing role in globalization and digital communication.
- Has the most speakers!

# English-speaking populations across various countries.

| Country        | Population    | Speakers    | First L     | Other L     |
|----------------|---------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| United States  | 312,092,668   | 297,400,000 | 244,232,103 | 42,155,719  |
| India          | 1,450,000,000 | 228,539,090 | 259,678     | 228,279,412 |
| Nigeria        | 206,200,000   | 125,039,680 | 20,000,000  | 103,198,040 |
| Pakistan       | 220,892,331   | 108,044,691 | 8,642       | 108,036,049 |
| United Kingdom | 64,000,000    | 62,912,000  | 59,072,000  | 3,840,000   |
| Philippines    | 110,000,000   | 70,117,935  | 36,935      | 70,081,000  |
| Germany        | 80,600,000    | 45,400,000  | 392,000     | 45,100,000  |
| Uganda         | 44,270,000    | 19,800,000  | 0           | 19,800,000  |
| France         | 67,500,000    | 38,643,750  | 0           | 38,643,750  |
| Canada         | 37,138,500    | 30,480,750  | 20,193,335  | 10,287,415  |
| Egypt          | 110,990,000   | 44,373,802  | 5,527,302   | 38,846,500  |
| Australia      | 23,401,892    | 21,715,910  | 17,020,421  | 4,695,489   |
| Bangladesh     | 165,323,100   | 19,838,772  | 709,873     | 16,398,158  |
| Poland         | 38,501,000    | 18,890,000  | 103,541     | 18,786,459  |
| Ghana          | 27,000,000    | 18,000,000  | 0           | 18,000,000  |
| Singapore      | 4,044,200     | 3,900,000   | 1,953,348   | 1,946,652   |

Data from Wikipedia: List of countries by English-speaking population.

## Quirk's Perspective (Uniformity View, 1985):

- Emphasizes a single, standardized form of English based on Inner Circle norms (e.g., UK, US).
- Concerns about intelligibility and global communication.
- Argues that legitimizing non-standard varieties risks misunderstanding.

*We need one standard English for effective international communication*

## Kachru's Perspective (Pluralist View, 1985):

- Advocates for the legitimacy of Outer Circle varieties (e.g., Indian, Nigerian English).
- Emphasizes linguistic and cultural adaptation (nativization).
- Critiques the deficit model of "errors" and promotes ownership of English by all its users. *English belongs to all its users, not just its historical 'native' speakers.*

# Key Themes of the Debate

- **Standardization vs. Diversity:**

- Quirk: Standardization is essential for global intelligibility.
- Kachru: Diversity reflects the realities of English use worldwide.

- **Pedagogical Implications:**

- Quirk: Teaching should adhere to Inner Circle norms.
- Kachru: Teaching should validate localized varieties.

- **Ownership of English:**

- Quirk: English belongs to the Inner Circle.
- Kachru: English is the global property of all its users.

# Four “False Assumptions” about English (Kachru, 1992)

## 1. The Homogeneity Assumption:

- **Assumption:** There is a single, homogeneous standard English.
- **Counterpoint:** Inner Circle varieties themselves exhibit variation.

## 2. The Deficit Model of Non-Native Varieties:

- **Assumption:** Outer Circle Englishes are “deviant” or deficient.
- **Counterpoint:** Outer Circle varieties are contextually legitimate adaptations.

## 3. The Pedagogical Purity Assumption:

- **Assumption:** Teaching should focus on Inner Circle norms exclusively.
- **Counterpoint:** Teaching should reflect local linguistic realities.

## 4. The Intelligibility Assumption:

- **Assumption:** Inner Circle norms guarantee mutual intelligibility.
- **Counterpoint:** Intelligibility is context-dependent and mutual.

# Innovation – Deviation – Mistake (Kachru, 1992)

## Key Distinctions:

- **Innovation:** Creativity in language use; often denied to Outer and Expanding Circle speakers.  
*Examples: timepass, skinship, add oil.*
- **Deviation:** Comparison with another variety; implies departure from a norm.  
*Example (vs. Inner Circle norm): He is knowing the answer.*
- **Mistake (or error):** Related to acquisitional deficiency; not accepted in any stable speech community.  
*Example: He knowed the answer.*

Different varieties are held to different standards!

## Three often-cited “standard” varieties:

- British English (BrE), North American English (especially AmE), and Australian English (AusE).
- Similarities and differences:
  - Across the three standards.
  - Across varieties within each region (e.g., different UK or US dialects).
- Pronunciation
- Vocabulary: The Most Noticeable Divergence (NAmE vs. BrE)
  - **Extended meanings:** e.g., *corn*, *robin*.
  - **New words:** e.g., *buttle* “to act as a butler”.
  - **Borrowings:** e.g., *moccasin*, *squash*, *toboggan*.
- Since US independence:
  - Technological terms: e.g., *windshield* vs. *windscreen*.

## Key Features:

- Borrowings from Aboriginal languages: e.g., *kangaroo*, *boomerang*.
- Unique slang words and phrases.
- Common use of abbreviations and clippings.  
*barbie* “bbq”, *uni* “university”, *sanger* “sandwich”, *relly* “relative”,  
*chuck a U-ey* “make a U-turn”  
*Snowy* “person with white hair”, *Bluey* “red-head”, *Bondie* “Bond (me)”

# Quite a lot of Grammar Differences

## AmE vs. BrE (Trudgill and Hannah, 2002):

- **Verbs:** Morphology, auxiliaries.
  - US: *He did already eat.* vs. UK: *He has already eaten.*
- **Nouns:** Endings, use of verbs as nouns.
  - US: *Please action this.* vs. UK: *Please do this/act on this.*
- **Adjectives and Adverbs:**
  - US: *He runs real fast.* vs. UK: *He runs really fast.*
  - US: *How big of a room is it?* vs. UK: *How big a room is it?*
- **Prepositions:**
  - US: *I went on the weekend.* vs. UK: *I went at the weekend.*

## Criticisms of NS/NNS Terms:

- NS = *native speaker*, NNS = *non-native speaker* (apparently simple labels, but problematic).
- Assumes monolingualism is the norm.
- Overemphasizes order of acquisition.
- Reinforces Anglo speakers as reference points.
- Implies unidirectional power relationships.
- Encourages simplistic views of "errors."
- What do these labels suggest about *you* as speakers of English?

# Alternatives to NS/NNS Distinction

## **Rampton (1990): "Experts" → Expertise**

- Advantages:
  - Learned, not innate.
  - Relative, partial, and contestable.
- Disadvantages:
  - "Non-expert" implies value judgment.

## **Jenkins (2000): MES, BES, NBES**

- MES: Monolingual English Speaker.
- BES: Bilingual English Speaker.
- NBES: Non-Bilingual English Speaker.
- Emphasizes speakers' bilingual repertoires rather than a simple native vs. non-native divide.

# Naming the Varieties: Labels and Ideology

**Names are not neutral:** they index attitudes, power, and ownership.

- **Indian English:** *Hinglish*

*Hinglish* highlights code-mixing and youth / pop-culture identities, but can also stereotype.

- **Singapore & Malaysian English:** *Singlish* / *Manglish*

In official discourse we often find *Colloquial Singapore English* (CSE). Government campaigns (*Speak Good English*) frame *Singlish* as a problem, while speakers use the name to index solidarity and local identity.

- **Hong Kong English:** *Chinglish*

Labels like *Chinglish* are common in media but are usually mocking or deficit-oriented, focusing on “errors” in signs or speech.

- **Japanese English, wasei-eigo:** *Japlish*, *Engrish*

*Japanese English* and *wasei-eigo* are descriptive terms used in linguistics. Informal labels like *Engrish* or *Japlish* are often used from outside Japan and carry racist / mocking connotations.

# Activity: How Would You Label Yourself?

- In small groups, discuss which labels you prefer:
  - NS / NNS
  - MES / BES / NBES
  - Something else entirely?
- How do these labels affect:
  - how confident you feel when speaking English?
  - how you evaluate other people's English?
- Who gets to name a variety (state, teachers, speakers, outsiders)?  
How do different labels affect the *prestige* and *legitimacy* of these Englishes?

## **Codification of Asian Englishes:**

- Importance:
  - Acceptance, prestige, classroom model.
- Obstacles:
  - Indigenized varieties seen as "interlanguages."
  - SLA perspective emphasizes NS-like competence.
  - Motivation for acquisition is integrative (admiration for NS culture).

## Distinct Features:

- **Phonology:** Unique accents and stress patterns (e.g., Indian English retroflex sounds).
- **Syntax:** Influence of local languages (e.g., omission of articles in Singapore English).
- **Lexicon:** Borrowings and cultural terms (e.g., *chop* “seal/stamp” in Malaysian English).
- Extensive code-switching

# What is Indian English?

- Indian English refers to the variety of English spoken in India.
- It is influenced by India's multilingual environment and local languages.
- Features unique vocabulary, pronunciation, grammar, and idiomatic expressions.
- Recognized as one of the most widespread second languages in India.

# Key Features of Indian English

- **Pronunciation:**

- Often rhotic: Pronouncing /r/ in words like *car* and *farm*.
- Vowel quality may differ from US/UK norms (e.g., *bat*, *bad*, *bed*).

- **Vocabulary:**

- Unique words like *prepone* (to reschedule earlier) and *godown* (warehouse).

- **Grammar:**

- Use of the progressive tense: *He is knowing the answer*.
- Use of *doubt* in the sense of “question”: *He is having a doubt in mathematics*.

# Unique Vocabulary in Indian English

- **Borrowed words:**

- *bungalow* (from Hindi: "bangla")
- *jungle* (from Hindi: "jangan")

- **Hybrid expressions:**

- *pass out* (to graduate)
- *out of station* (not in town)

- **Local adaptations:**

- *hill station* (mountain resort)
- *timepass* (leisure activity)
- *revert* (reply — also used in Manglish/Singlish)

# Examples of Indian English Sentences

- *Can you prepone the meeting to tomorrow?*
- *I passed out of college in 2020.*
- *He is having a doubt in mathematics.*
- *She went to the market to buy vegetables only.*
- *Let us go for a walk in the evening, no?*

# Cultural and Linguistic Significance

- Indian English reflects the diversity of India's languages and cultures.
- It bridges communication gaps in a multilingual society.
- Used in government, education, business, and media.
- Contributes to the global spread of English with a distinct identity.

# What is Singlish?

- Singlish is the colloquial form of English spoken in Singapore.
- It combines English with elements from Malay, Tamil, Hokkien, Cantonese, and other languages.
- Singlish is informal and often spoken in casual settings.
- Although not officially endorsed, it is a key part of Singaporean identity.

# Examples of Singlish Vocabulary

- **Lah:** *Don't worry lah!* (adds emphasis or assurance)
- **Kiasu:** *He is so kiasu.* (fear of missing out)
- **Shiok:** *This food is so shiok!* (delicious or enjoyable)
- **Blur:** *Why are you so blur?* (confused or clueless)
- **Paiseh:** *So paiseh to ask!* (embarrassed)
- **Ang moh:** *The ang moh loves laksa.* (Caucasian - lit: red head)

Try our Singlish Dictionary!

- **Aspect through adverbs, not tense:**

- *He go already.* (He has already gone.)

- **Tag particles:**

- *You want coffee, ah?* (adds a questioning tone)
- *Very expensive, leh.* (adds emphasis)

- **Omission of articles/plurality:**

- *I go market.* (I am going to the market.)
- *I buy 3 book.* (I will buy three books.)

# Cultural and Linguistic Significance

- Singlish reflects Singapore's multicultural heritage.
- It fosters a sense of local identity and camaraderie.
- Often used in media, humor, and casual conversations.
- Despite government efforts to promote Standard English, Singlish remains a vibrant and unique aspect of Singaporean culture.

# What is Hong Kong English?

- Hong Kong English is the variety of English influenced by Cantonese, the primary language spoken in Hong Kong.
- Developed due to British colonial rule (1842–1997) and remains significant in education, business, and law.
- Reflects a blend of British English, local linguistic features, and Cantonese cultural influence.

# Key Features of Hong Kong English

- **Pronunciation:**

- Influence of Cantonese tones on stress patterns.
- Some speakers may neutralize /r/ and /l/, producing similar sounds in words like *rice* and *lice*.

- **Grammar:**

- Omission of articles and prepositions: *I go market* (I am going to the market).

- **Vocabulary:**

- Loanwords from Cantonese: *yum cha* (drink tea) and *char siu* (roast pork).

# Examples of Hong Kong English Vocabulary

- **Loanwords from Cantonese:**

- ***Dai pai dong:*** Open-air food stalls.
- ***Si fu:*** Master or skilled worker.
- ***Cha chaan teng:*** Hong Kong-style cafes.

- **Hybrid expressions:**

- ***Add oil:*** An encouragement or cheer, meaning *keep going* or "good luck."
- ***Long time no see:*** Often described as a calque from the Cantonese phrase "好耐冇見" (hou noi mou gin), though the exact origin is debated.

# Common Features of Sentences in Hong Kong English

- **Direct translations from Cantonese:**

- *He very smart, la.* (He is very smart, you know.)

- **Different grammatical elements:**

- *I no understand.* (I do not understand.)

- **Unique phrases:**

- *I go yum cha with family tomorrow.* (I am going to have dim sum with my family tomorrow.)

# Cultural and Linguistic Significance

- Hong Kong English reflects the region's colonial past and its Cantonese-speaking majority.
- It plays a key role in education, government, and international business.
- Highlights the blending of British and Chinese cultures in Hong Kong.
- Despite its informal and localized nature, it remains an essential aspect of Hong Kong's identity and communication in multilingual settings.

# What is Japanese English?

- Japanese English refers to the variety of English influenced by the Japanese language.
  - Informal labels like *Japlish* or *Engrish* are sometimes used for English produced by Japanese speakers, often in a mocking or racist way.
  - 和製英語 *wasei eigo* “Japanese-made English” are English-like words used in Japanese.
- It often features adaptations of English words and phrases to fit Japanese phonetics and culture.
  - Inserting vowels: *table* becomes *te-buru*.
  - No distinction between /l/ and /r/: *light* and *right* sound similar.
  - Fewer consonant clusters
  - A tendency to shorten things
- Developed due to English education, international business, and cultural exchange.
- Known for unique loanwords, katakana usage, and creative expressions.

# Examples of Wasei Eigo

## ● Adapted loanwords:

- *sarariman* (salaryman) “male office worker”
- *o-eru* (OL: office lady) “female office worker”
- *hando phon* (hand phone) “Mobile phone (from *handy phone*)”
- *baikingu* (viking) “buffet” (because Scandinavians like *smorgasbord*)

## ● Creative coinages:

- *mai pe-su* (my pace) “going at one’s own speed”
- *seku-hara* “sexual harassment”
- *pawa-hara* (power harassment) “workplace bullying”
- *konbini* “convenience store”
- *sukinshippu* (skinship) “physical closeness or bonding”
- *ha-to furu* (heartful) “warm-hearted, caring”

# Cultural and Linguistic Significance

- Japanese English showcases the cultural blending of Japan and the English-speaking world.
- Reflects creative adaptations to fit Japanese language structure and social norms.
- Plays an important role in education, tourism, and advertising in Japan.
- Despite challenges with pronunciation and syntax, it has become a unique and recognizable form of English globally.

# The Future of Asian Englishes

## Trends:

- Increasing prestige and global recognition.
- Growth of English as a second language in Asia.
- Integration into educational systems and digital platforms.

## Key Questions:

- How will globalization shape Asian Englishes?
- Will codification lead to the emergence of new standards?
- How can we balance intelligibility and diversity?

# Prestige and “Non-Standard” Varieties in the Inner Circle

- **Australian English** (*Strine*) Historically stigmatized as “broad” or “lazy” English; now an accepted national standard. (Burridge and Mulder, 1999)
- **African American Vernacular English (AAVE)** (*ebonics*) A rule-governed, systematic variety with distinctive grammar (e.g. copula absence, habitual *be*). Frequently stigmatized despite high linguistic complexity and cultural prestige (music, media). (Rickford, 1999)
- **Appalachian / Southern US English** Often mischaracterized as “incorrect”; has unique grammatical systems (e.g. a-prefixing: *He’s a-running*, multiple modals *I shoulda coulda done it*). Example of **overt vs. covert prestige**. (Lippi-Green, 2012)
- **British regional dialects** (Scouse, Geordie, Glaswegian) Local prestige but low institutional prestige; hard for outsiders to understand.

**Takeaway:** The ideology that Inner Circle Englishes are uniform “standards” is false: all Englishes exhibit prestige hierarchies

# Linking Inner-Circle Variation to Asian Englishes

The same social processes shaping variation in Inner Circle Englishes also affect Asian Englishes.

- **Covert prestige:** Speakers may value a stigmatized variety as an identity marker. *Strine*, *AAVE*, *Singlish* all show strong in-group solidarity.
- **Standard language ideology** The belief that one form of English is inherently “better”. Used to delegitimize AAVE, regional UK dialects, and Asian Englishes (e.g. Indian English, HK English).
- **Error vs. innovation:** Just as AAVE grammatical rules were long misclassified as errors, many Asian English features start as “deviations” but become recognized innovations.
- **Ownership of English:** Debates around AAVE in schools parallel arguments about whether Indian English or Singlish should be taught, legitimized, or standardized.
- Understanding Inner-Circle diversity helps avoid seeing Asian varieties as special cases: *all Englishes are dialects*. (Milroy and Milroy, 1999)

# Conclusion

- Asian Englishes showcase the dynamic evolution of the language.
- They are key to understanding the future of global English.
- How established they are depends on their size and prestige.

# Activity: Innovation, Deviation, or Mistake?

Decide in pairs how to classify each sentence. For each one, ask:

- Is this an **innovation** (accepted in some community)?
- A **deviation** (different from a chosen standard)?
- Or a **mistake** (not accepted anywhere)?

- (1) *Can you prepone the meeting to tomorrow?*
- (2) *Yesterday I go market, very crowded, lah.*
- (3) *He is knowing the answer.*
- (4) *She is 22 years.*
- (5) *This food is damn shiok!*
- (6) *They knowed the answer.*
- (7) *I need to control my homework.*
- (8) *I beez in the trap.*

**Whose norms are you using when you decide?**

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